Foreword

The mission of Ruby on Rails has always been to enable the single developer to do it all: build a front-end, build a back-end, build everything needed to take a great web application from HELLO WORLD to launch and beyond. Over the past two decades, countless developers have done just that, and some of the most important web apps on the Internet are powered by Rails because of this.

But building a business on the Internet today now often requires more than just building for a generic browser. In many industries, native applications for iOS and Android have become table stakes. And the work required to build these using the official toolkits often turns out to be orders of magnitude more than the web app. In many cases, this means it’s simply unrealistic for a single developer to do it all.

Hotwire Native changes that for Rails developers. By using the power of Hotwire, you no longer have to replace the entire web app, and constantly keep it in sync, with a duplicated set of native applications for the two dominant platforms. Instead, you can let that wonderful web app be the basis for everything, wrap it in a great, native shell for navigation, and only build native interactions where it’s really needed.

That’s what we do at 37signals for both Basecamp and HEY, our project management and email+calendar systems. The vast majority of the screens in these applications are the same as they are for the web app version, only with custom CSS to tweak the presentation for the smaller screen. This has